This lab guide will walk you through the process of hosting a website on a Windows EC2 instance using Internet Information Services (IIS).

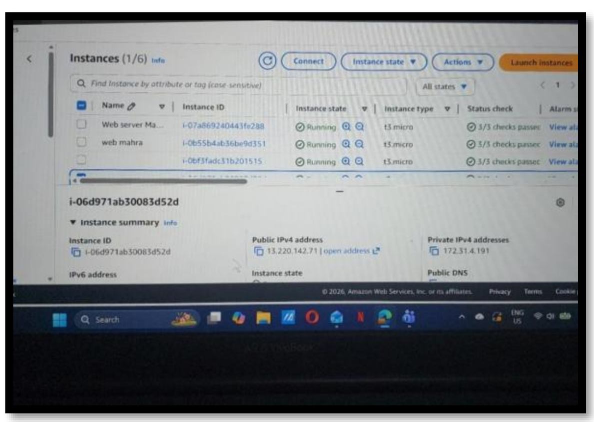
Lab Objective

To launch a Windows Server on AWS, install the IIS web server role, and deploy a custom website that is accessible via the public internet.

Step 1: Launch a Windows EC2 Instance

1. **Select AMI:** Log into the AWS Management Console and choose **Windows Server 2016** as your Amazon Machine Image (AMI).
2. **Instance Type:** Select **t2.micro** (1 vCPU, 1 GB RAM) to stay within the free tier.
3. **Network Settings:**
   - Ensure a **Public IP** is enabled so the website can be accessed externally.
   - Keep the default VPC and subnet settings.
4. **Storage:** Use the default **32 GB** General Purpose SSD (gp2) root volume.
5. **Security Group:** Create a security group with the following inbound rules:
   - **RDP (Port 3389):** To connect to the server from your laptop.
   - **HTTP (Port 80):** To allow public access to your website.
6. **Key Pair:** Select an existing key pair or create a new one to retrieve the administrator password later.

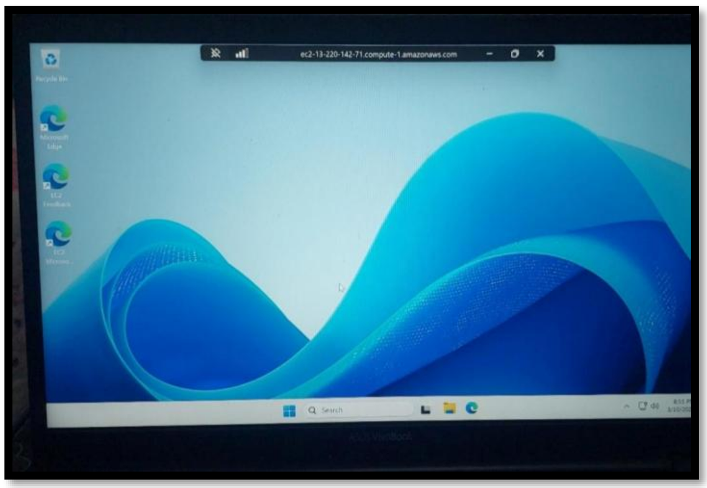
Answer Key 1:



Step 2: Connect to the Instance

1. Wait approximately 4 minutes after launching for the instance to initialize.
2. Select the instance and click **Connect**, then go to the **RDP client** tab.
3. Click **Get Password** and upload your private key file to decrypt the administrator password.
4. Download the **Remote Desktop File**, open it, and enter the decrypted password to log in.

Answer Key 2:



Step 3: Disable IE Enhanced Security (Optional but Recommended)

1. Open **Server Manager** from the Taskbar.
2. Click on **Local Server** in the left pane.
3. Locate **IE Enhanced Security Configuration**, click "On," and set it to **Off** for Administrators to allow easier file downloads within the server.

Step 4: Install the Web Server (IIS) Role

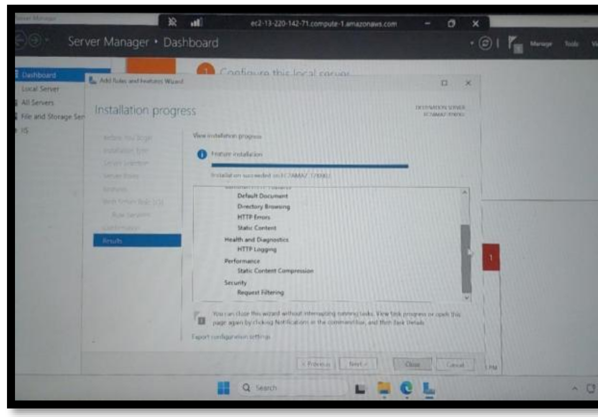
1. In Server Manager, click **Manage** > **Add Roles and Features**.
2. Follow the wizard (Next, Next) until you reach **Server Roles**.

3. Check the box for **Web Server (IIS)** and click "Add Features" when prompted.
4. Continue through the wizard and click **Install**.

Answer Key 3:

Step 5: Verify the Default Website

1. Copy the **Public IP** of your instance from the AWS console.
2. Paste it into a browser on your local laptop.
3. You should see the blue **IIS Windows Server default page**.



Step 6: Deploy Your Custom Website

1. Inside the EC2 instance, download or create your website files.
2. Navigate to the default web directory: **C:\inetpub\wwwroot**.
3. **Delete** the existing default IIS files (iisstart.htm and the logo).
4. **Paste** your custom website files (index.html, CSS, images) into this folder.
5. Refresh the browser on your local laptop using the same Public IP. Your custom website should now appear.

Answer Key 4: